

PROGRAMME IMPROVEMENT PLAN

IndiaFOSS 2027 How to Build On This Year

A companion to the IndiaFOSS 2026 Programme Analysis — concrete, numbers-driven ideas for next year's Call for Proposals, venue planning, and community outreach.



This is an internal planning document, generated by an AI assistant (Claude), not an official FOSS United / IndiaFOSS publication. Built on the same public dataset as the main programme analysis (sessions, booths, sponsors, general knowledge of India's FOSS landscape), plus **a public list of 324 rejected CFP submissions** used in Section 2 — provided directly as a file by the organiser, the same convenience as `cfp-all.csv` in the main report, rather than fetched by this session from IndiaFOSS's own CFP dashboard (an authenticated organiser view, which was not used here). The devroom attribution in Section 2 is this report's own estimate from titles — that field isn't in the original data — so it should be checked against the actual devroom managers' sense of their own rejects before anyone acts on it. Workshop and room-count figures throughout are planning estimates, not commitments.

Prepared as a follow-up to `if2026-summary.pdf`, using the same session/booth/sponsor dataset, plus reasoning grounded in general knowledge of India's FOSS community landscape. See the note on data sources at the end of each section.

Executive Summary

IndiaFOSS 2026 was diagnosed as strong on embedded-systems depth, community culture, and an unusually dense "producer" ratio — but thin on hands-on workshops for its deepest tracks, and short several devrooms (Data, Policy, Telecom, Creative-Experience) that were proposed and not selected, purely on capacity grounds. This companion report turns those findings into four concrete moves for 2027:

38

CANDIDATE NEW WORKSHOPS IDENTIFIED

9–17

TOTAL ROOMS NEEDED, BY AMBITION TIER

2

DEVROOMS THAT MOST NEED MORE ROOM

12+

COMMUNITIES WORTH INVITING

1. **Turn producers into workshop leads.** Every devroom, a meaningful slice of the booth floor, and 14 already-written proposals that were rejected purely for lack of room together give 38 concrete candidates by name — no new pitching required for at least 22 of them.
2. **Give Hardware and Cloud & DevOps more room next year.** Both rejected an estimated ~75% of their submissions this year, by far the tightest of the 8 devrooms; AOSP, by contrast, accepted most of what it received and needs outreach more than space.
3. **Plan the venue math** for folding workshops (and a third, busier BoF room) into the two conference days instead of a separate pre-conference day, under the stated seat-capacity constraints — three tiers, a 9-room pilot up to a 17-room full ambition.
4. **Invite named communities** that map directly onto this year's gaps and could plausibly run a devroom as a mini-conference version of their own yearly event.

1. Turning producers into workshop leads

This year's 8 pre-conference workshops came entirely from individual proposals — none from the devrooms or the 75-booth community floor, even though both groups clearly have the hands-on expertise (the booth floor alone runs 6 hardware-focused tables and several teaching-oriented projects). If IndiaFOSS asked each devroom for one workshop, and invited a subset of technically hands-on booths to do the same, here's a concrete, named starting list — *proposals for the organising team to pitch to these specific groups, not commitments they've made*.

1a. One workshop per devroom (8)

Devroom	Candidate workshop	Why this devroom can run it
RTOS	Flash & debug Zephyr on real hardware	Directly closes the sharpest gap this year's analysis found — the deepest devroom has zero hands-on time.
AOSP	Build & flash a custom AOSP image	11 sessions already cover bring-up, HALs and bootloaders in depth.
Compilers	Write your first LLVM pass	Run by LLVM Social Bangalore — a standing community, not a one-off organiser.
Hardware	PCB design & soldering 101	Run by absurd.industries, who already staff a hardware booth and could combine both roles.
Security	Userspace sandboxing / binary RE walkthrough	Highest average depth (6.8/10) outside RTOS; strong practical case studies already exist.
Cloud & DevOps	Kubernetes observability with Perses/Prometheus	Run by Point Blank, who also handle much of the event's own on-ground infra.
Documentation & Technical Writing	Docs-as-code: ship a living documentation pipeline	11 sessions of practitioner experience, currently talk-only.
Design	Build a design system from scratch	Zero lightning talks this year — this devroom already favours depth over breadth.

1b. Sixteen booth-sourced candidates

Picked from the 75-booth floor for having a teachable tool or process, not just an awareness message:

Booth / project	Candidate workshop
CircuitVerse	Digital logic design with CircuitVerse
Jupyter	Building interactive notebooks & extensions
SciPy India	Scientific computing with NumPy/SciPy
FOSSEE	Teaching with Scilab/Python: an educator's workshop
FreeBSD Project	Getting started with FreeBSD
Debian	Packaging for Debian: your first package
F-Droid	Publish your first app on F-Droid

Booth / project	Candidate workshop
GOSH (Open Science Hardware)	Open science hardware build session
Ampere Works	Electronics prototyping 101
T-01 The Explorer	Build a mini robot
Xeneva	OS development fundamentals
Rethink DNS + Firewall	Build your own network privacy tool
Bahmni	Configuring a health facility in Bahmni
webminal.org	Linux terminal bootcamp
Idlistack (Tech4Good)	Deploy your first app on an open PaaS
Data For India / OpenCity / Samaajdata (joint)	Civic data wrangling workshop

That last one is worth flagging on its own: a joint civic-data workshop run by three booths that already do this work daily would be a direct, low-risk way to partially answer the rejected "Building with Open Data in India" devroom pitch without waiting for a full devroom slot.

1c. The lowest-effort path: 14 workshops already exist, rejected only for lack of room

The organiser-supplied rejected-proposals list shows **14 Workshop-type proposals were submitted this year and turned down** — not for lack of interest, but presumably because the pre-conference day had no more room. Re-inviting these authors for 2027 is far lower-effort than the speculative lists above, and several land squarely on gaps this report and the main analysis already flagged:

- **Mastering Firmware Testing with Renode: From Unit Testing to CI/CD with Code Coverage** — directly extends the RTOS devroom into hands-on territory, the single sharpest gap in the main report.
- **Beyond Emulation: Hardware-in-the-Loop Testing on Shared Remote Boards** — same RTOS/embedded gap, a second independent pitch at it.
- **Mindful App Installation with F-Droid** — matches the F-Droid booth candidate in 1b almost exactly; this one already has a committed author.
- **How did we write an Operating System from scratch? Learn & experience XenevaOS** — matches the Xeneva booth candidate in 1b; again, an author already stepped forward.
- **Adding roads and buildings to OpenStreetMap (indoor workshop)** — a second, complementary OSM workshop alongside this year's outdoor one.
- **Hands-on usage of CoRE stack datasets and APIs for social-ecological planning** — a hands-on companion to this year's accepted CoRE Stack talk.
- **Recipes and Runtimes: Making Sense of Containers in 2026, Using AI with K3s and Kubectl, Building Agentic AI Systems with Small Language Models** — three separate Cloud/AI-infrastructure workshop pitches, reinforcing how much unmet AI-tooling appetite exists (the main report found ~20 AI-related sessions scattered with no home).

The remaining rejected workshops (contributor-experience design thinking, a Qt-based Mankala game engine, an SDLC coding-agent workshop) are lower-priority but still real, ready-to-run submissions.

The headline number

8 devroom-sourced + 16 booth-sourced + 14 already-submitted-and-rejected = 38 candidate workshops (with some overlap between the booth and already-rejected lists — F-Droid and Xeneva appear in both), on top of the 8 that already ran. Even a conservative conversion — say the 14 real submissions plus half the speculative 24 — is a workshop day roughly three times this year's size, which is exactly the venue-planning question Section 3 works through.

1d. Encouraging producers to run BoFs too

This year's BoF pool was small and not very oversubscribed: 14 formal submissions (11 accepted, 3 rejected — a ~79% acceptance rate, per the organiser-supplied rejected-proposals list), covering topics like cooperatives, micro-granting, and community governance. A BoF is a much lower-effort ask than a workshop — no slides, no curriculum, just a room and a topic — so it's a natural second lever for turning producers into active participants rather than passive presenters.

Devrooms (8): each could run an informal town-hall alongside its regular sessions — e.g. "AOSP Roadmap: What's Next", "RTOS Practitioners Meetup", "Compiler Toolchain Roundtable" — one per devroom, mirroring the workshop-per-devroom idea in 1a.

Booths — the "Community" category is the natural source (12 candidates): FOSS United Mangalore, COSH NITK, SciPy India, FOSS4G.IN, Wikimedians of Kerala, Open Data Kerala, XMPP Standards Foundation, TinkerSpace, Homebrew at HSP, OASIS, GOSH, and Future of the Commons — all already community-facing rather than pure product demos, and a BoF is closer to what they're already doing at their table than a workshop would be.

The BoF headline number

8 devroom-sourced + 12 booth-sourced = 20 candidate new BoFs, against this year's 11 accepted — call it **roughly a tripling of BoF volume** if even most convert. Section 3's room count folds in a dedicated third BoF room to absorb this.

2. Should any devroom get a longer slot?

The organiser supplied the full list of 324 rejected CFP submissions separately (title, session type, and status — no track field). That list doesn't say which devroom each rejected talk was aimed at, so this section **estimates** it by matching each rejected title's vocabulary against the themes of this year's *accepted* sessions in each devroom (e.g. a rejected title mentioning "Kubernetes" or "observability" is counted toward Cloud & DevOps). This is title-only keyword matching with no description text to check it against, so treat every number below as directionally useful, not exact — a proper pass would have the actual devroom managers sort their own rejects.

Devroom	Accepted	Est. rejected	Est. acceptance rate	Reading
Hardware	6	~20	~23%	Strongest case for more room — rejected 3 of every 4 estimated submissions.
Cloud & DevOps	10	~32	~24%	Strongest case for more room — by far the most estimated submissions of any devroom.
Security	9	~19	~32%	Secondary candidate — meaningfully oversubscribed.
Compilers	11	~10	~52%	Moderately subscribed; current slot looks about right.
Documentation & Technical Writing	11	~10	~52%	Moderately subscribed; current slot looks about right.
RTOS	10	~8	~56%	Comfortably subscribed, despite running the deepest content (7.6/10) — its gap is the missing workshop (Section 1), not slot length.
Design	7	~4	~64%	Comfortably subscribed.
AOSP	11	~3	~79%	Under-subscribed, not over — accepted most of what it received. Better served by outreach to attract more proposals than by a longer slot.

Recommendation

Hardware and Cloud & DevOps are the clearest candidates for a longer slot or a second parallel session next year — both estimated to reject roughly three-quarters of what they received, and Cloud & DevOps alone accounts for an estimated ~32 of the ~106 devroom-track rejects this method could classify. Security is a reasonable secondary candidate. AOSP is the opposite case: its high accept rate suggests it should spend 2027 recruiting more submissions before asking for more room. This directly revises a hypothesis floated earlier in this planning process (that RTOS or Compilers were most oversubscribed) — worth remembering that a plausible-sounding guess from depth/format alone was wrong once real submission volume was checked.

Of the 324 rejected submissions, an estimated 218 didn't match any devroom's vocabulary clearly enough to classify — most are likely General Track submissions (talks, lightning talks, BoFs, and panels reviewed directly by the Programme Committee), a separate rejection pool from the devroom-specific one analysed here.

3. Venue math for folding workshops into the conference days

This assumes a **new venue for 2027** — not the same building as 2026. This year's room sizes (Hall 1: 840, Hall 2: 250, Hall 3: 120, Room 1: 120, Room 2 & 3: 35 each) are used only as reference points for "roughly how big" each room type needs to be; the spec below is a room-count and capacity target to hand to whoever selects the 2027 venue, not a delta against this year's building. This year's pattern (General Track in the two largest rooms, two parallel devrooms per half-day slot, two small rooms for BoFs, and workshops pushed to a separate pre-conference day for lack of room) is the starting model; folding workshops into the two conference days, and adding a third BoF room for the growth in Section 1d, are the two structural changes.

The slot structure

Two days, each with a morning and a post-lunch session, gives **4 macro-slots** total. Folding workshops in means every workshop occupies one full macro-slot in a 35–50 seat room, the same pattern devrooms already use (each devroom occupies exactly one macro-slot, which is why 8 devrooms need only 2 rooms running at 2-per-slot).

Track type	Rooms needed	Seat size	Notes
General Track	2	~250–850	Something similar to this year's Hall 1 & Hall 2, every slot.
Devrooms	2	~120–250	Room count doesn't change even if some devrooms get a longer slot (Section 2) — that changes duration, not how many run in parallel, since 8 devrooms already average 2-per-slot.
BoFs	3	~35	2 as before, plus 1 new room to absorb the roughly tripled volume from encouraging producer-run BoFs (Section 1d: ~20 candidates against this year's 11 accepted). Still runs more continuously than the 4-slot model.
Workshops — Pilot (8 devroom-sourced only)	2	35–50	$8 \div 4$ macro-slots = 2 parallel. Just Section 1a.
Workshops — Realistic (+ 14 already-submitted)	6	35–50	$22 \div 4 \approx 6$ parallel. Section 1a + the real, already-written 1c proposals — no new pitching required.
Workshops — Full ambition (~40)	10	35–50	All of 1a + 1b + 1c (minus overlaps) $\div 4 \approx 10$ parallel.

The bottom line — three tiers, pick one

Pilot (8 devroom-sourced workshops only, plus the extra BoF room from 1d): **9 rooms total** — 2 general + 2 devroom + 3 BoF + 2 workshop. Directly fixes the "deepest devrooms get zero hands-on time" finding with the smallest possible venue ask.

Realistic (pilot + the 14 workshops already written and rejected this year, Section 1c): **13 rooms total** — same 7 for General/Devroom/BoF, plus 6 workshop rooms. This tier needs no new outreach at all — every one of those 22 workshops already has an author who volunteered.

Full ambition (everything in Section 1, roughly 40 workshops once overlaps are removed): **17 rooms total** — the same 7 plus 10 workshop rooms, running in every one of the 4 macro-slots. This is the

honest ceiling on what a two-day, four-slot structure can hold; going further would mean either more days or fewer parallel workshops per slot.

All three tiers assume workshops distribute evenly across the 4 macro-slots. In practice, some slots (e.g. the last one before closing) typically see lower attendance and demand — worth weighting the schedule so the busiest workshops don't compete for the same slot as the closing keynote or GB elections.

4. Communities worth inviting for 2027

These are informed suggestions grounded in this year's data and general knowledge of India's FOSS landscape — not confirmed commitments. Each should be validated with the named organisation before being counted on.

4a. Communities that map directly onto this year's rejected devroom pitches

Rejected pitch	Communities to approach	Why
Building with Open Data in India	DataMeet, plus this year's Data For India / Open Data Kerala / OpenCity / Samaajdata booths	DataMeet already runs recurring civic-data meetups nationally; the booths give a ready-made speaker bench.
Tech Geopolitics and Policy	Internet Freedom Foundation, Centre for Internet & Society, plus this year's SFLC.in booth	All three are established Indian digital-policy organisations with conference-ready speakers.
Open Cellular Communication	India-based Open RAN / OpenAirInterface contributors, Free Software Community telecom groups	Fills the one genuinely unaddressed technical gap — no booth or session this year touched telecom infrastructure.
FOSS at the Edge of Experience	Processing/p5.js India community, Godot India meetup groups	Creative-coding and open game-dev communities exist in India but weren't represented this year.

4b. Established communities that could run a devroom as a mini-conference

- **SciPy India** — already a booth; running their own annual conference, a natural "Scientific Computing" devroom.
- **FOSS4G.IN** — already a booth; mirrors the global FOSS4G geospatial conference format, and overlaps with this year's OpenStreetMap content.
- **PyCon India** organisers — a dedicated Python devroom, distinct from the general software content already in the General Track.
- **Rust India** meetup groups — this year had scattered Rust content (an HDL talk, a Stable AIDL talk) with no dedicated home.
- **CNCF India** chapters — could formalise or co-run the Cloud & DevOps devroom alongside Point Blank.
- **GNOME Asia** community — a desktop-specific devroom, complementing this year's one-off GTK/Bézier-curves talk.

4c. Digital commons & Wikimedia-adjacent overlap

- **Wikimedia India / CIS-A2K** (Centre for Internet & Society's Access to Knowledge programme) — broader national Wikimedia presence, beyond this year's regional Kerala chapter booth.
- **ICFOSS** (International Centre for Free and Open Source Software, a Kerala government body) — notable given how South-India-concentrated this year's attendance already is (58% from five southern states); ICFOSS's government-FOSS and Malayalam-computing work is a natural fit.
- **Open Knowledge India** — open-data and open-culture overlap with several of this year's booths.
- **Free Software Movement of India** chapters outside Kerala/Karnataka — a deliberate lever against the regional concentration finding, if the goal is a more pan-India draw.